

Surrounded by the chilly greyscale fog that envelopes the countless trees at my every turn. The only hint of color can be found among the hills of fallen leaves of muted oranges and yellows of autumn. One or two bright dandelions were the only ones not to be touched by this foggy plague. A different kind of beauty for the forest is already the epitome of beauty in itself. Glancing over to chase the faded sound of the crunching gray leaves I see a cat with fur blending perfectly in with the muddy fog and piercing yellow eyes that contrasted the forest the same way those few dandelions did.

The cat led me to a clearing where I was able to make out the distant and vague shape of what I thought was a house. Upon further inspection I realized it was far from my assumption. It was an oddly shaped cave. This cave however, must've served as a home for the countless bugs and plants living within. The cat lay deep within the cave as if to draw me further. Bones, so many bones. I let out a quick sigh of relief when I noticed these bones are much too small to be those of a human. But somehow that thought is much more chilling than when I thought they belonged to people. I rushed backwards toward the exit from which I entered but as soon as I turned around it was gone. Lost to the dark and her endless mysteries.

I look down at my feet and notice that the cat that had led me here, had disappeared from my sight as well. I couldn't see past my calves. Everything below it was lost to fog. I look up, it's oddly not as dark as everything else. I notice a small etching that could only mean so much or so little without my knowing. The further I look into it I begin to lose my balance which sends me falling back into the darkness. Water, I fell into a sea of mirrors that seemed to go on endlessly. Until it didn't. As I fell through it I lost track of where each of my limbs were, I was dazed, confused. I fell for what felt like ages to the point where falling backwards felt like falling forward and around.

It began to feel like the sea was pushing me back onto my feet, like I could finally stand upright. Stable. I was standing the same as I had been before. I wearily reopened my eyes to make sure the salt water had not blinded me. I look down to evaluate the toll taken on my clothes from the rippling tides. I was dry. The same way I was before I fell. Before I went into that chilling cave. I was where I started. In the forest, greyscale and cool, with only a patch of bright yellow dandelions from the corner of my eye. Trying to process what had just happened, I am approached by not a cat, but myself, in greyscale, with piercing yellow eyes to contrast the lifeless forest.